

GROW.

8-Week Glute Program for Women 35+

Build. Shape. Strengthen.

GROW

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INCLUDES

- 4 versions: Beginner + Intermediate / Home + Gym
- Nutrition basics for muscle growth
- 3 days a week / 8 weeks
- Progress + recovery system

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"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge." — Both apply here.

GROW · 8-WEEK GLUTE PROGRAM · FEMININE STRENGTH CO.

WHY GLUTES DON'T GROW

What most women are doing wrong

01

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

01 — WHY GLUTES DON'T GROW

Most women are training glutes. They're just not training them right.

If you've been squatting, lunging, and doing donkey kicks for months and your glutes look exactly the same — you're not broken. Your program is just missing a few things that make the actual difference.

The Three Things That Drive Muscle Growth

- Mechanical tension — the muscle under heavy load. This is why hip thrusts, not bodyweight squats, build glutes. You need resistance your glutes actually have to fight against.
- Metabolic stress — the burn. Higher rep sets, shorter rest, the pump. This is where band work and finishers live.
- Muscle damage — the soreness after RDLs. The lengthened position under load. This is what drives the repair process that makes the muscle grow.

All three matter. Most programs only train one. This program trains all three, every week.

The Mind-Muscle Connection

Before you can grow your glutes you have to be able to feel them. This sounds obvious but most women squeeze their quads and lower back and think they're working their glutes. They're not.

Before every session — especially in week 1 — do this: lie on your back, feet flat, and do 10 slow bodyweight glute bridges. Squeeze at the top and hold for 2 seconds. Focus entirely on feeling the contraction in your glutes, not your hamstrings, not your lower back. If you can't feel it here, you won't feel it under a barbell.

The glute-mind connection is a skill. It takes a few weeks to build. Don't skip the activation work in the early weeks — it's not a warm-up, it's training.

Three Planes of Movement

The glutes don't just extend the hip. They also abduct (move the leg out to the side) and externally rotate. Most programs only train the sagittal plane — forward and backward. This program trains all three.

Plane	Movement	Exercises
Sagittal (forward/back)	Hip extension	Hip thrusts, RDLs, squats, step-ups
Frontal (side to side)	Hip abduction	Lateral band walks, clamshells, cable abductions
Transverse (rotational)	External rotation	Cable pull-throughs, banded squats, sumo stance work

The Hip Thrust Is the King

No other exercise loads the glutes at peak contraction the way a hip thrust does. Squats are quad dominant. Deadlifts hit the posterior chain broadly. The hip thrust targets the glutes specifically at the exact point of maximum activation. It is in every version of this program, every week, for all 8 weeks.

- Beginner: start with bodyweight, then DB across the hips, then barbell
- The goal by week 8: a weight that challenges you for 8–12 reps with full control
- Clients of mine have worked up to 225–235 lbs on the hip thrust. That didn't happen in week one. It happened because of consistent progressive overload over months.

You will not get there staying at 25 lbs. Progressive overload is the entire point. Add weight when you own the top of the rep range with 2 reps left in the tank.

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THE NUTRITION BASICS

You cannot grow what you do not feed

02

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

02 — NUTRITION BASICS

You cannot out-train under-eating.

Building muscle requires energy. Not just the energy to get through the workout — the energy to repair and rebuild after it. If you are chronically under-eating, your body does not have the raw material to build anything. This is the number one reason women train hard and see no change in their shape.

Fat loss and muscle growth can happen together — but only if you're eating enough protein and not slashing calories to the point where your body has nothing to build with.

Calories and Muscle Growth

You do not need to eat in a large surplus to build muscle — especially if you're newer to training. What you need is to eat at or slightly above maintenance, hit your protein target, and fuel your training days properly. Eating like a bird while training three days a week is a guarantee that nothing changes.

Goal	Calorie Approach	What It Means
Build muscle + lose fat (body recomposition)	Eat at maintenance	Bodyweight × 14–15. Best for beginners and returning trainees.
Prioritize muscle growth	Slight surplus	Add 100–200 calories above maintenance. Slower fat loss, faster muscle gain.
Not seeing results	Check your protein first	Before adding calories, make sure you're hitting protein. Most women aren't.

Protein Requirements for Growth

Protein is the building block of muscle. Without enough of it, your body cannot repair the muscle fibers you broke down in training. For muscle growth, your target is higher than for fat loss.

Goal Weight	Daily Protein for Growth
120–130 lbs	100–130g / day
131–145 lbs	110–145g / day
146–160 lbs	120–160g / day
161–175 lbs	135–175g / day
176–190 lbs	150–190g / day
191+ lbs	160–200g / day

Aim for 30–40g per meal across 3–4 meals. Spread evenly — not 10g at breakfast and 80g at dinner.

Pre + Post Workout Nutrition

When	What	Why
60–90 min before training	Protein + carbs. Eggs on toast, yogurt + fruit, shake + banana.	Carbs fuel the session. Fed training = heavier lifts = more stimulus for growth. Training fasted on a muscle-building program is a bad trade.
Within 1–2 hours after	Your biggest protein meal + carbs. This is your most important meal of the day on training days.	This is when your muscles are most primed to absorb protein and begin repair. Don't skip or delay this meal.
On rest days	Same protein target. Slightly lower carbs if you want — but don't slash calories on rest days.	Your muscles are still repairing on rest days. Under-eating on rest days slows the process.

Your protein and your fiber. Every meal. If you do nothing else from this section, do that.

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BEGINNER PROGRAM — GYM

3 days a week · 8 weeks · Full equipment

03

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

03 — BEGINNER / GYM

BEGINNER · GYM

Gym equipment available

8 Weeks. 3 Days. Start Here.

You have access to a gym. You are new to structured glute training or returning after a long break. Start at Tier 1 for every exercise. Own the movement before you add weight. Week 5 is always a deload — same exercises, 60% effort.

Weeks 1–4: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Glute Bridge (bodyweight)	3 × 15	6	Squeeze at top, hold 2 sec. Feel the glutes, not your lower back.	Add DB across hips when 15 reps feel easy
DB Hip Thrust (bench)	3 × 12	7	Upper back on bench, DB across hips. Drive through heels, squeeze at top.	Increase DB weight when top of range feels easy
DB Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10	7	Hinge at hips, soft knee. Feel hamstring load before you pull.	Add 5–10 lbs when form is solid
Leg Press — feet high + wide	3 × 12	7	High foot placement shifts demand to glutes. Full depth.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Banded glute bridge	1 × 20	8	Band just above knees. Drive knees out. Squeeze every rep.	Increase band resistance

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Lateral Band Walk	3 × 15 ea.	6	Band above knees. Stay low, steps controlled. Don't let feet come together.	Heavier band when 15 feels easy
Clamshell (banded)	3 × 15 ea.	6–7	Side-lying, band above knees. Rotate top knee up — don't let hip rock back.	Heavier band, add hold at top
Cable or Band Kickback	3 × 12 ea.	7	Hinge slightly, drive heel back and up. Squeeze at the top.	Add cable weight or heavier band

Sumo Goblet Squat	3 × 12	7	Wide stance, toes out. Sit into the squat, drive knees out on the way up.	Add DB weight weekly
Finisher: Standing abduction (cable)	2 × 15 ea.	7	Attach ankle cuff, drive leg out to side. Controlled return.	Add weight when all reps controlled

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust (bench)	4 × 10	7–8	This week goes heavier than Day A. Same form, more load.	Push the weight — this is your heavy day
Reverse Lunge (DB)	3 × 10 ea.	7	Step back, not out. Front shin stays vertical.	Add DB weight weekly
Cable Pull-Through	3 × 12	7	Hinge at hips, let cable pull you back. Drive hips forward to stand.	Add weight weekly
Seated Hip Abduction (machine)	3 × 15	7	Full range, controlled return. Don't let the weight bang.	Add weight when 15 feels easy
Glute Focused Step-Up	3 × 10 ea.	7	Drive through heel on the box, squeeze glute at top, controlled step down.	Increase box height or add DB

Week 5 is a deload. Same exercises, same days, ~60% of your working weight. Full range of motion, full control. This week is not optional.

Weeks 6–8: Progression

More load · harder variations · same discipline

Weeks 6–8: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell or Heavy DB Hip Thrust	4 × 8	8	Progress to barbell if form is solid. Drive through heels, full extension at top.	Add 5–10 lbs each week
Single-Leg RDL (DB)	3 × 10 ea.	7–8	Hip stays square. Control the balance. Feel the hamstring load.	Add DB weight as balance improves

Barbell or DB RDL	3 × 10	8	Heavier than weeks 1–4. Slow 3-sec lowering phase.	Add weight weekly
Bulgarian Split Squat (DB)	3 × 8 ea.	8	Rear foot elevated. Front foot forward. Start lighter than you think.	Add weight when depth is consistent
Finisher: Hip thrust iso hold	3 × 10s hold	—	At top of hip thrust, hold for 10 seconds. Squeeze hard.	Extend hold to 15 sec

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Cable Hip Abduction	3 × 15 ea.	7–8	Ankle cuff on low cable. Drive leg out to side, controlled return.	Add weight weekly
Clamshell — 3 sec hold at top	3 × 12 ea.	7	Heavier band. Hold at top for 3 seconds before lowering.	Extend hold, heavier band
Cable Kickback	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	Heavier than weeks 1–4. Full range, squeeze at top.	Add weight weekly
Sumo Deadlift (DB or BB)	3 × 8	8	Wide stance, toes out, drive hips through at the top.	Add weight when form is solid
Finisher: Banded squat walk	2 × 20 steps	8	Band above knees, stay low, walk laterally. Feel the burn.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell Hip Thrust — heavy	4 × 6	8–9	This is your heaviest session of the week. Load up and earn it.	Push the weight — 2 reps left in tank
Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 10 ea.	8	One leg at a time. Control the descent, drive through working heel.	Add weight when stable for all reps
Deficit Reverse Lunge	3 × 10 ea.	8	Stand on a small plate. Greater range, more glute demand.	Increase step height or add weight
Cable Pull-Through — pause at hinge	3 × 12	7–8	Pause for 2 sec at the bottom of the hinge. More tension.	Add weight weekly
Seated Hip Abduction — 3 sec lowering	3 × 12	7–8	Slow eccentric. Control the weight back in — no letting it drop.	Add weight weekly

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BEGINNER PROGRAM — HOME

3 days a week · 8 weeks · Bands + Dumbbells

04

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

04 — BEGINNER / HOME

BEGINNER · HOME

No gym. No problem. Same results.

You need resistance bands (light, medium, heavy) and a set of dumbbells. For hip thrusts you'll use a couch or sturdy chair for your upper back. The principles are identical — progressive overload, all three planes, consistency.

Equipment needed: Resistance bands (3 levels), dumbbells (range of weights), sturdy couch or bench for hip thrusts, yoga mat.

Weeks 1–4: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Bodyweight Glute Bridge	3 × 15	6	Feet flat, drive through heels, squeeze and hold 2 sec at top.	Progress to single-leg when 15 feels easy
DB Hip Thrust (couch)	3 × 12	7	Upper back on couch edge, DB across hips. Same cues as gym version.	Increase DB weight weekly
DB Romanian Deadlift	3 × 10	7	Hinge at hips, soft knee, feel the hamstring stretch before pulling up.	Add weight when form is solid
Sumo DB Squat	3 × 12	7	Wide stance, toes out, drive knees out on the way up.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Banded glute bridge	1 × 20	8	Band just above knees. Drive knees out every rep.	Heavier band

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Lateral Band Walk	3 × 15 ea.	6–7	Band above knees. Low position. Controlled steps. Don't let feet close.	Heavier band
Clamshell (banded)	3 × 15 ea.	6–7	Side-lying. Band above knees. Rotate top knee up, hold 2 sec.	Heavier band + add hold

Donkey Kick (banded)	3 × 15 ea.	7	Band around feet. Kick leg back and up, squeeze at top.	Heavier band
Reverse Lunge (bodyweight or DB)	3 × 10 ea.	7	Step back, front shin stays vertical. Drive through front heel to return.	Add DB weight
Finisher: Banded squat pulse	1 × 20	8	Band above knees. Stay low, small pulses. Feel the burn.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust (couch) — heavy day	4 × 10	8	Go heavier than Day A. This is your max effort hip thrust day.	Push the weight
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	One leg extended. Drive through working heel. Hips stay level.	Add DB across hip
Good Morning (DB or bodyweight)	3 × 12	7	Bar or hands behind head, hinge at hips. Feel hamstrings stretch.	Add very light DB to increase challenge
Curtsy Lunge (DB)	3 × 10 ea.	7	Step back and across. Glute of front leg does the work.	Add DB weight
Finisher: Banded fire hydrant	2 × 15 ea.	7	On all fours, band above knees. Drive knee out to side. Squeeze.	Heavier band

Week 5: Deload. Same movements, ~60% effort. Your body is consolidating the work from weeks 1–4.

Weeks 6–8: Progression

Heavier bands · single-leg work · more demand

Weeks 6–8: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust — heavier	4 × 8	8	Heaviest DB you have. Full extension, full squeeze, controlled descent.	Add weight every session if possible

Single-Leg RDL (DB)	3 × 10 ea.	7–8	Balance. Hip stays square. Feel the stretch at the bottom.	Add DB weight as balance improves
DB RDL — 3 sec lowering	3 × 10	8	Slow eccentric. The lowering phase drives the growth.	Add weight weekly
Bulgarian Split Squat (DB or bodyweight)	3 × 8 ea.	8	Rear foot on couch. Front foot forward. Controlled depth.	Add weight when depth is consistent
Finisher: Iso hip thrust hold	3 × 10s hold	—	At top of hip thrust — hold for 10 seconds. Squeeze hard.	Extend hold time

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Standing Banded Abduction	3 × 15 ea.	7–8	Band around ankles. Stand on one foot, drive other leg out to side.	Heavier band
Clamshell — slow tempo	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	3 sec up, 3 sec down. Heaviest band you have.	Heavier band
Banded Kickback — pause at top	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	Pause 2 sec at full extension. Squeeze the glute hard.	Heavier band
Sumo DB Deadlift	3 × 8	8	Wide stance, toes out. Heavy. Drive hips forward at the top.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Lateral band walk + squat	2 × 10 ea.	8	3 steps lateral, squat, 3 steps back. Band above knees.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Single-Leg Hip Thrust (couch)	3 × 10 ea.	8	One leg at a time. Full extension. No dropping the hips.	Add DB weight across hip
Banded Glute Bridge — 3 sec hold	3 × 12	8	Heavy band above knees, drive knees out. Hold 3 sec at top.	Heavier band
Curtsy Lunge — weighted	3 × 10 ea.	8	Hold DB. Step back and across, front glute drives you up.	Add weight weekly

Good Morning — weighted	3 × 12	7–8	Hold DB at chest or goblet style. Hinge deep, feel hamstrings.	Add weight
Finisher: Banded squat walk	2 × 20 steps	8	Band above knees, stay low, walk laterally both directions.	Heavier band

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INTERMEDIATE PROGRAM — GYM

3 days a week · 8 weeks · Barbell + Cables

05

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

05 — INTERMEDIATE / GYM

INTERMEDIATE · GYM

Gym equipment available

You've built the base. Now we build the glutes.

You've been training consistently. You know the movements. This version uses the barbell hip thrust as the primary driver, adds cable work for the abduction plane, and increases the demand through tempo, single-leg variations, and heavier loading.

The barbell hip thrust is the centerpiece of this program. If you haven't done it before, start lighter than you think and learn the setup. The form is more important than the weight — especially in week 1.

Weeks 1–4: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell Hip Thrust	4 × 10	7–8	Upper back on bench, barbell across hips with pad. Drive through heels, full extension, squeeze hard at top.	Add 5–10 lbs when top of range feels easy
Barbell RDL	3 × 10	7–8	Hinge at hips, bar stays close to legs. Feel hamstring stretch. 3-sec lowering.	Add weight weekly
Leg Press — high + wide foot placement	3 × 12	7	High on platform, wide stance. Full depth. Drives glutes over quads.	Add weight weekly
Cable Kickback	3 × 12 ea.	7	Ankle cuff on low cable. Hinge slightly. Drive heel back and up. Squeeze.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Banded hip thrust	1 × 15	8	Add band above knees to your last set. Drive knees out while thrusting.	Use with heaviest working weight

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
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Cable Hip Abduction	4 × 15 ea.	7	Ankle cuff on low pulley. Drive leg out to side, controlled return.	Add weight weekly
Clamshell (heavy band)	3 × 15 ea.	7	Heavy band above knees. Full range, 2 sec hold at top.	Heavier band + longer hold
Sumo Deadlift	3 × 8	7–8	Wide stance, toes out. Drive through floor, hips forward at lockout.	Add weight when form is solid
Glute-Focused Step-Up	3 × 10 ea.	7	High box, drive through heel, squeeze glute at top before stepping down.	Add DB or increase box height
Finisher: Lateral band walk + pulse	2 × 15 ea.	8	Band above knees. 15 lateral steps then 10 pulses in low squat.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell Hip Thrust — heavy	4 × 8	8	Heavier than Day A. This is your heavy session. 2 reps left in the tank.	Push weight every week
Bulgarian Split Squat (BB or DB)	3 × 8 ea.	8	Rear foot elevated. Focus on front glute doing the work.	Add weight when depth is consistent
Cable Pull-Through	3 × 12	7–8	Hinge, drive hips forward. Don't rush the hinge back.	Add weight weekly
Seated Hip Abduction (machine)	3 × 15	7–8	Full range. Slow on the way in — eccentric matters.	Add weight when 15 feels easy
Finisher: Hip thrust drop set	1 × failure	9	One heavy set to failure, drop 30%, go again immediately.	Increase starting weight

Week 5: Deload. Non-negotiable. Drop to 60% across the board. Your body consolidates muscle between sessions — the deload is where weeks 6–8 get built.

Weeks 6–8: Progression

Heavier · single-leg · tempo work

Weeks 6–8: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell Hip Thrust — 3 sec lowering	4 × 8	8–9	3-second lowering phase. Same weight as week 4 or slightly heavier. The tempo makes it harder.	Add weight when tempo feels controlled
Single-Leg RDL (BB or DB)	3 × 8 ea.	8	Hip stays square. This is the hardest RDL variation. Own the balance first.	Add weight as balance improves
Deficit RDL	3 × 10	8	Stand on a small plate. Greater range of motion, more hamstring + glute stretch.	Increase deficit or add weight
Bulgarian Split Squat — pause at bottom	3 × 8 ea.	8–9	2-sec pause at the bottom. No bouncing out of the hole.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Single-leg hip thrust iso	3 × 8s ea.	—	At top of single-leg hip thrust, hold 8 seconds. Squeeze hard.	Extend hold time

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Cable Hip Abduction — 3 sec hold	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	Drive leg out, hold 3 sec at full abduction. Slow return.	Add weight weekly
Clamshell — banded + DB	3 × 12 ea.	8	Heavy band + hold light DB on working hip for extra load.	Increase weight or band
Sumo Deadlift — heavy	3 × 6	8–9	Heavier than weeks 1–4. Explosive up, controlled down.	Add weight weekly
Glute Step-Up — pause at top	3 × 10 ea.	8	Pause 2 sec at the top with full hip extension before stepping down.	Add DB or increase pause
Finisher: Abduction mechanical drop set	1 set	9	Cable abduction to failure, switch to band, continue to failure.	Increase cable starting weight

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Barbell Hip Thrust — max load	4 × 6	9	Heaviest you've done. This is your PR session. Every week.	Beat last week by even 2.5 lbs

Single-Leg Hip Thrust	3 × 10 ea.	8–9	Barbell or heavy DB. One leg. No excuses.	Add weight when all reps controlled
Cable Pull-Through — slow tempo	3 × 12	8	4-sec lowering into the hinge. Drive hips aggressively forward.	Add weight weekly
Hip Abduction Machine — slow eccentric	3 × 12	8	3-sec lowering. Eccentric is where the muscle damage happens.	Add weight when tempo feels easy
Finisher: Barbell hip thrust AMRAP	1 × max reps	10	60–70% of max. As many reps as possible with perfect form.	Record reps — beat it next week

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INTERMEDIATE PROGRAM — HOME

3 days a week · 8 weeks · Progressive Band + DB

06

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

06 — INTERMEDIATE / HOME

INTERMEDIATE · HOME

Home doesn't mean easy. It means consistent.

You have been training. You know the movements. This version pushes the home setup as hard as possible — heavier DBs, multiple band levels, single-leg variations, and tempo work that makes lighter weights significantly harder.

To get maximum results from this version you need: heavy resistance bands (3 levels including heavy/X-heavy), dumbbells up to at least 40–50 lbs, and a sturdy couch or ottoman for hip thrusts.

Weeks 1–4: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust (couch) — heavy	4 × 10	7–8	Heaviest DB you have. Upper back on couch edge. Full extension, 2 sec squeeze.	Add weight every week
Single-Leg Glute Bridge	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	One leg extended. Drive through working heel. Add DB across hip.	Increase DB weight
DB RDL	3 × 10	7–8	Both hands, hinge deep. 3-sec lowering phase.	Add weight weekly
Sumo DB Squat — wide stance	3 × 10	7	Wide, toes out. Sit deep, drive knees out on the way up.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Banded hip thrust burnout	1 × 20	8	Heavy band above knees + bodyweight. Drive knees out every rep.	Heavier band

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
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Standing Banded Abduction	4 × 15 ea.	7–8	Heavy band at ankles. Balance on one foot. Drive leg out to side.	Heavier band
Clamshell — tempo (3 sec up, 3 sec down)	3 × 12 ea.	8	Heaviest band. No rushing. The slow tempo makes it significantly harder.	Heavier band
Banded Kickback + hold	3 × 12 ea.	7–8	Heavy band. Drive heel back and up, hold 2 sec, controlled return.	Heavier band
Lateral Band Walk + squat combo	3 × 12 ea.	8	3 steps lateral, 1 squat. Band above knees. Stay low.	Heavier band
Finisher: Fire hydrant — 3 sec hold	2 × 12 ea.	8	On all fours. Drive knee out and up, hold 3 sec. Heavy band.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust — single leg	3 × 10 ea.	8	One leg at a time. DB across working hip. Control the descent.	Add weight when stable
Curtsy Lunge (weighted)	3 × 10 ea.	8	Heavier DB. Step back and across, front glute drives you up.	Add weight weekly
Good Morning — DB	3 × 12	7–8	Hold DB at chest. Hinge deep. Feel hamstrings stretch at bottom.	Add weight
DB Sumo Deadlift — heavy	3 × 8	8	Wide stance, toes out. Drive hips through at lockout.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Banded hip thrust drop set	1 set	9	Heavy band to failure, switch to medium band, continue to failure.	Increase starting band resistance

Week 5: Deload. Drop to 60%. Same movements, full range of motion, zero heroics. This is not optional.

Weeks 6–8: Progression

Single-leg focus · tempo · maximum load

Weeks 6–8: Foundation

3 days · Rest at least 1 day between sessions

Day A — Hip Dominant

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Single-Leg DB Hip Thrust	4 × 10 ea.	8–9	Heaviest DB you can control for all reps. No cheating the range.	Add weight when all reps are controlled
DB RDL — 4 sec lowering	3 × 10	8	4-second eccentric. The slowest, hardest version of this movement.	Add weight when tempo feels manageable
Bulgarian Split Squat (DB)	3 × 8 ea.	8–9	Rear foot on couch. Pause 2 sec at the bottom of each rep.	Add weight when pause stays controlled
Banded Hip Thrust + abduction	3 × 12	8	Heavy band above knees. Drive knees out against the band every single rep.	Heavier band
Finisher: Single-leg bridge iso	3 × 10s ea.	—	Hold at top of single-leg bridge for 10 sec. Squeeze hard.	Extend hold time

Day B — Abduction + Posterior Chain

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
Standing Banded Abduction — slow	3 × 12 ea.	8	3 sec out, 3 sec back. Heaviest band. Control every inch.	Heavier band
Clamshell — X-heavy band + hold	3 × 10 ea.	8–9	Heaviest band you have. Hold at top for 3 sec. Full range.	Extend hold time
Banded Kickback — slow eccentric	3 × 12 ea.	8	Drive back and up, hold 2 sec, take 3 sec to return.	Heavier band
Sumo DB Deadlift — heavy	3 × 6	8–9	Heaviest DB. Drive hips through aggressively at the top.	Add weight weekly
Finisher: Lateral walk + fire hydrant combo	2 rounds	9	10 lateral steps + 10 fire hydrants each side. No rest between.	Heavier band

Day C — Full Glute + Accessory

Exercise	Sets × Reps	RPE	Coaching Cue	Progression
DB Hip Thrust — AMRAP final set	3 × 10 + AMRAP	9	3 working sets, then drop 20% and do max reps on final set. Record it.	Beat reps each week

Curtsy Lunge — pause at bottom	3 × 10 ea.	8–9	2-sec pause at bottom. DB in hands. Front glute drives you up.	Add weight
Single-Leg RDL (DB)	3 × 8 ea.	8	Balance. Hip square. Feel the stretch. Add weight as balance allows.	Add weight
Good Morning + rotation	3 × 10 ea.	7–8	Hinge, then rotate toward the floor leg. More rotational glute demand.	Add DB weight
Finisher: Full burnout circuit	1 round	10	20 banded bridges + 15 fire hydrants ea. + 15 kickbacks ea. No rest.	Complete circuit without stopping

GROW · 8-WEEK GLUTE PROGRAM · FEMININE STRENGTH CO.

PROGRESS + RECOVERY

Photos, rest days, and what growth actually looks like

07

"You cannot grow what you do not feed and you cannot build what you do not challenge."

Growth happens between sessions.

The session creates the stimulus. Recovery is where the actual growth happens. If you are training three days a week and sleeping five hours a night while under-eating, you are creating the damage without giving your body the tools to rebuild. Recovery is not optional. It is the other half of the program.

Progress Photos — How to Actually Do It

Photos are the most honest measurement tool you have for glute development. The scale will not show you muscle gain. Your tape measure will not capture shape. Photos will.

What	How	Why
Frequency	Every 2 weeks. Same day of the week, same time of day.	Daily or weekly photos create false comparisons. Two weeks gives enough time for visible change.
Angles	Front, side, and back. All three, every time.	Glute shape changes most visibly from the side and back. Don't skip these angles.
Lighting	Same lighting every time. Natural light near a window works well.	Lighting changes how muscle definition appears dramatically. Inconsistent lighting creates false comparisons.
Clothing	Same outfit or similar. Form-fitting so you can actually see the shape.	Baggy clothing hides change. You need to be able to see the actual shape.
Time of day	Morning, before eating if possible.	Bloating and food volume affect how you look. Morning gives the most consistent baseline.

Take the photos even when you don't feel like you're making progress. The transformation is always more visible when you compare week 1 to week 8 side by side.

What to Expect Week by Week

When	What You Might Notice
Weeks 1–2	Soreness — especially after Day A and Day C. This is normal. It means the stimulus is new. It will reduce as you adapt.
Weeks 3–4	The movements start to feel more natural. You'll start feeling your glutes working during the exercises. This is the mind-muscle connection building.
Week 5 (Deload)	You might feel like you're losing progress. You're not. Your body is consolidating. Most people feel stronger after deload week.
Weeks 6–7	The weights are going up. The exercises are harder. This is where the real stimulus happens. Stay consistent.

Week 8

Compare your photos from week 1 to now. The change in shape is usually most visible here. Keep going — 8 weeks is a start, not a finish.

Rest Days

Rest days are not wasted days. They are training days — just a different kind. On rest days your body repairs micro-tears in the muscle fibers you created during training. This repair process is what makes the muscle bigger and stronger. Skipping rest days does not make you work harder. It makes the repair incomplete.

- 3 training days means 4 non-training days. Use them.
- Light walking on rest days is fine — it improves circulation and speeds recovery
- Sleep 7+ hours. This is where growth hormone releases. No sleep = no growth, no matter how hard you train.
- Eat your protein on rest days too — your muscles are still rebuilding

You do not get stronger in the gym. You get stronger recovering from the gym. Protect your rest days like they're training sessions — because they are.

8 weeks is the beginning. It takes 3–6 months of consistent training to see real, lasting shape change in the glutes. This program gives you the foundation and the system. What you do after week 8 is where the real transformation lives. Questions? Find me on Instagram @christin_fisher. — Christin This program is general fitness guidance, not medical advice. Check with your doctor before starting, especially if you have existing health conditions.